

In Topic 1, you learnt about the five project management process groups and their relation to the 10 project management knowledge areas. Now, let's explore project integration management as the first knowledge area in the PMBOK (Project Management Body of Knowledge), considered a critical success factor for project managers.

In this topic, you will watch videos, complete readings and participate in discussions to understand the application of project integration management.

But, before you begin, participate in the discussion below.

 **Discuss**



Project integration management

1. Watch this video "Project integration management [2.54 min]" to learn about the importance of project integration management and how it impacts all of a project's processes.

What is Project Integration Management? Don't Ignore These 7 Critical Project Integration...



© 2021 by ProjectCubicle Business. *Project integration management*

2. **Share** your answers to the following questions via the padlet below.
 - What are some of the key takeaways from the video?
 - What are the seven processes of project integration management?
3. **Review** your classmates' posts. Is there anything in their experience that is new to you? Comment constructively on at least two posts.

Project integration management is the coordination of all elements of a project. This includes coordinating tasks, resources, stakeholders, and any other project elements, in addition to managing conflicts between different aspects of a project, making trade-offs between competing requests, and evaluating resources. Integrated project management ensures projects are not managed in isolation. It takes into account not only how aspects of your project relate to each other but also how other parts of the organization relate to your project. These integration management processes occur throughout the entire project lifecycle as it is an ongoing task that needs to happen continuously.

”

(Wrike, n.d.)

Why is project integration management so important?

Process integration management ensures that all elements of a project are aligned and coordinated effectively to improve the project’s performance. It also helps a project adapt to sustained changes in the highly dynamic business environment.

Seven processes of project integration management

Not every knowledge area requires you to do a task in each process group. But for project integration management, this is involve each stage (initiating, planning, executing, monitoring and controlling, and closing).

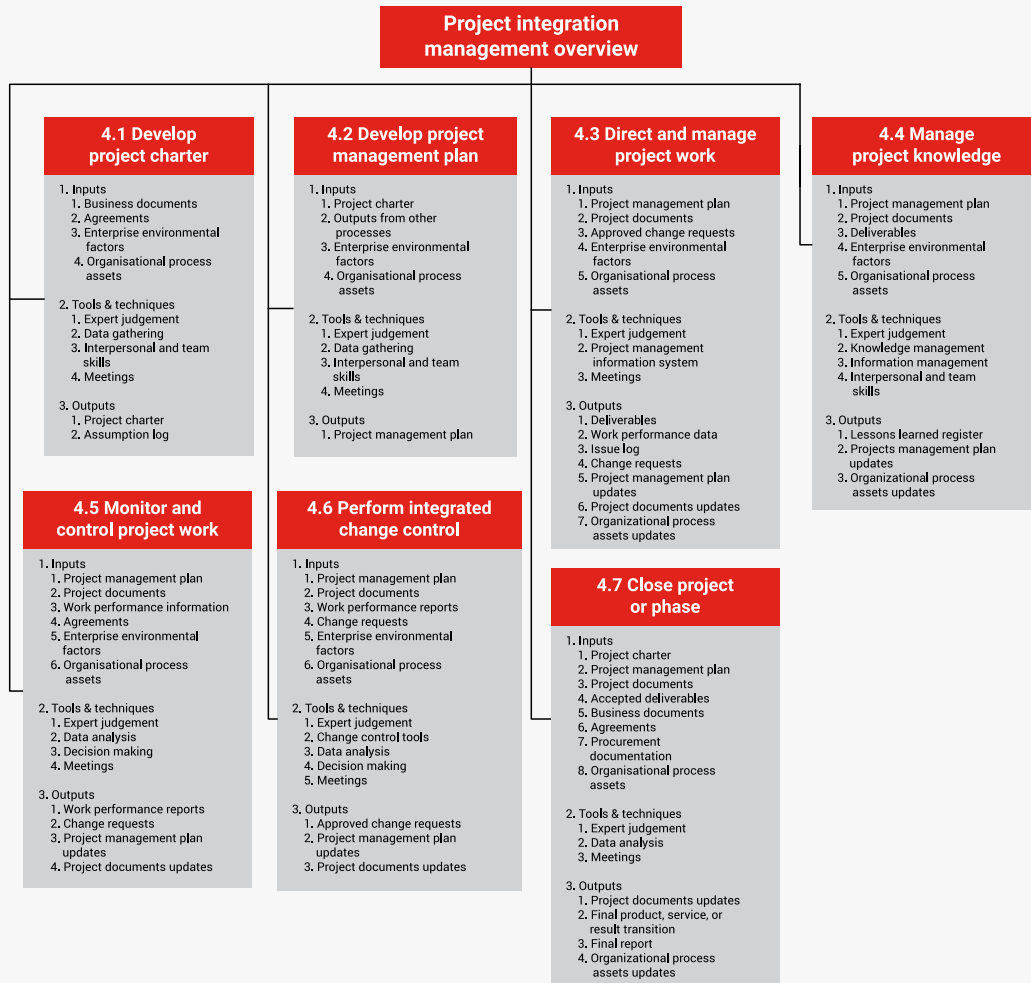
Table 2.3 shows seven processes that should be followed for successful project integration management.

Table 2.3 Project integration management processes	
Initiating Process: develop the project charter Output: project charter	A project charter is a formal, typically short document that describes your project in its entirety, including the objectives, stakeholders and how it will be carried out. It is a crucial ingredient in planning the project because it is used throughout the project life cycle.
Planning Process: develop the project management plan Output: project management plan	Contracts have been signed, hands have been shaken and a new project is officially underway, with you at the helm. But when it comes to planning a new project, you may not know exactly where to begin. What is a project management plan? How do you predict with accuracy how long tasks will take? How do you translate stakeholder expectations into concrete deliverables? What if something goes wrong? Your project management plan is the key to a successful project, with minimal stress.

Executing Process: direct and manage project work Outputs: deliverables, work performance data, change requests, project management plan updates, project documents updates	You've analysed the various methodologies, chosen the frameworks most suited to your project, your team and your objectives, and found a project management tool that fits your needs. Throughout the entire project life cycle, working together with each team member will ensure you all function as a cohesive unit. But just because you've selected the right people to accomplish the work doesn't mean they will always collaborate in the best way. Different work habits, communication styles, and short- and long-term goals can throw your entire team (and the project) off track. Clarifying the behaviour you want your team to practise and establishing key values from the beginning starts everyone on the right foot.
Manage project knowledge	Knowledge is power. Knowledge management (KM) in project management requires a programmatic approach that combines people, processes, tools and — of course — information, to satisfy project managers' needs for knowledge. We will explore how just-in-time access to knowledge in the normal course of work, knowledge sharing in a community of practice and a formal learning curriculum tied to career path and competency requirements are essential to success in any organisation.
Monitoring and controlling Process: monitor and control project work Outputs: change requests, project management plan updates, project document updates Process: perform integrated change control Outputs: approved change requests, change log, project management plan updates, project documents updates	With any project, there are limitations and risks that need to be addressed to ensure the project's ultimate success. The three primary constraints that project managers should be familiar with are time, scope and cost. These are frequently known as the triple constraints or the project management triangle. Each constraint is connected to the other two; so, for example, increasing the scope of the project will likely require more time and money, while speeding up the timeline for the project may cut costs, but also diminish the scope. Perform integrated change control is the process of reviewing all change requests; approving changes and managing changes to deliverables, project documents and the project management plan; and communicating the decisions. This process reviews all requests for changes to project documents, deliverables or the project management plan and determines the resolution of the change requests. The key benefit of this process is that it allows for documented changes within the project to be considered in an integrated manner while addressing overall project risk, which often arises from changes made without consideration of the overall project objectives or plans. This process is performed throughout the project.
Closing Process: close project or phase	Final product, service or result transition; organisational process assets updates.

Adapted from [What Is Project Integration Management?](#) © Wrike, n.d.

Figure 2.7 summarises the inputs, tools and techniques, and outputs of project integration management according to PMBOK® (6th edition).

Figure 2.7*Project integration management overview*

(Click to expand the image)

© PMI, 2017

[\[Image transcript\]](#)**Watch**

Watch this video "Project integration management [1.07 min]" for a quick story about using project integration management.

Project Integration Management



© 2016 by Nick Christian. *Project integration management*

← References

Jump to...



Strategic planning process →

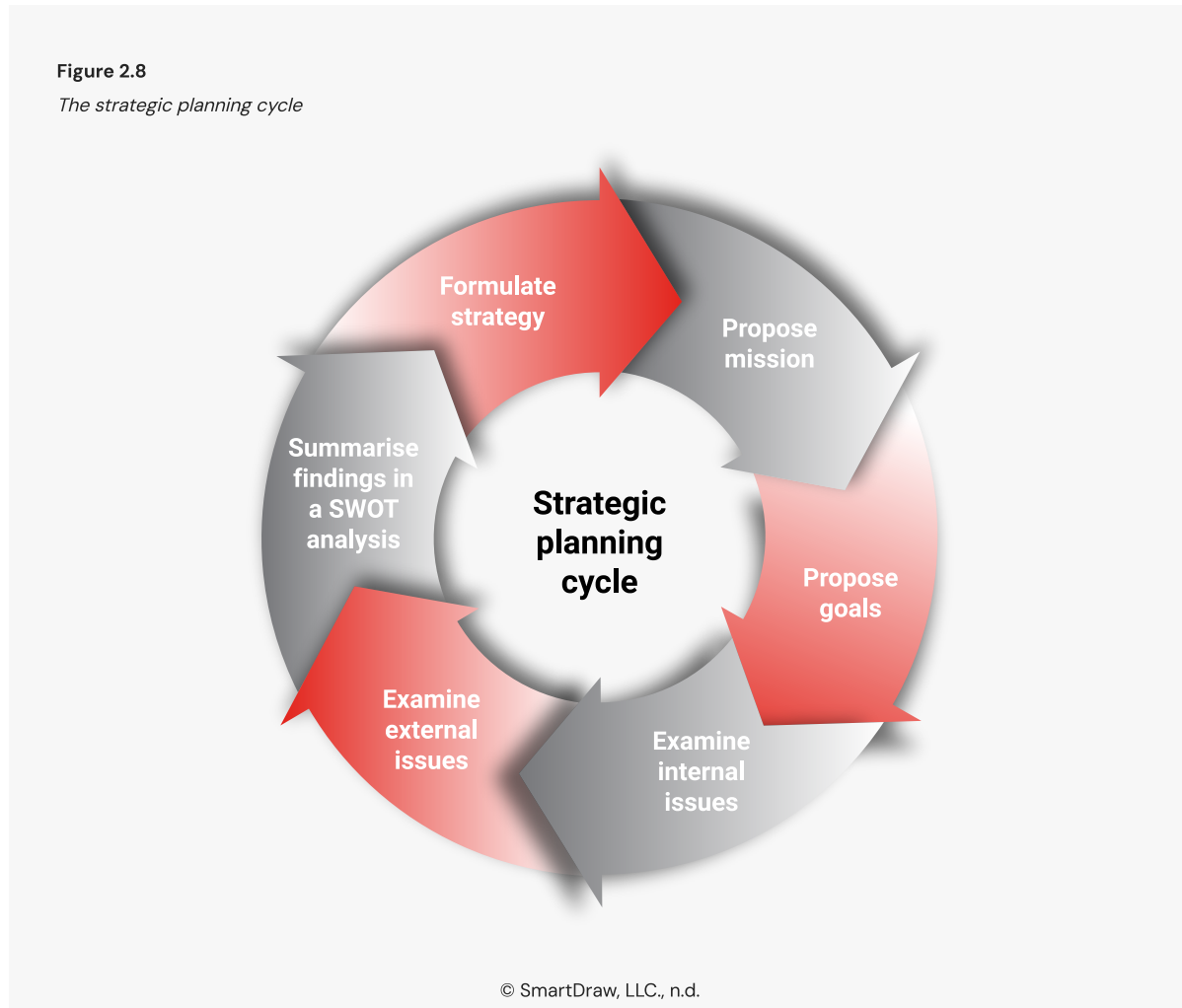
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Aligning project goals with business strategies is an essential contributory factor to successful project delivery. It's also important for prioritising projects, adapting to change and obtaining executive support. Therefore, before organisations start projects, they should go through the strategic planning process to decide which projects better suit the business needs.

Figure 2.8 illustrates the strategic planning cycle.



Watch

This video "The steps of the strategic planning process [11.04 min]" will walk you through each step of the strategic planning process to give you an overview of all the work that goes into developing a strategic plan.

Strategic Planning Process: 5 Key Steps in 15 Minutes



© 2017 by SME Strategy. *The steps of the strategic planning process*

← [Topic 4: Project integration management](#)

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[Project initiation](#) →

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Project initiation is the first step in starting a new project adventure. In this phase, you determine the reasons or motivations for starting the project and, most importantly, what value it will deliver. This is the foundation to secure buy-in from key stakeholders.

“

The project initiation phase empowers you to lay a strong foundation for your project. It ensures that you prove the business need for your project, secure necessary approvals, confirm the feasibility of your work, and start to assemble your team.

With that done, you're free to finalize the details of your project plan and determine your specific objectives, deliverables, milestones, and project roadmap. So happy planning, and here's to many great project beginnings (and project successes) to come.

”

(MacNeil, 2021)



The project initiation phase lays the foundation and directions of the project management life cycle. It ensures that the project initiatives will add the desired business value in line with the organisation's strategies. It also helps the stakeholders to establish a common understanding of the expected outcomes of the project to facilitate more effective communication in the later phases.

Once you have secured your stakeholders, it is time to start developing your project charter.

“

PMBOK® Defines Project Charter as a document issued by the project initiator or sponsor that formally authorizes the existence of a project, and provides a project manager with the authority to apply organizational resources to the project. PMI® gives a lot of importance to project charter. Project Charter will state the high-level requirements to satisfy the stakeholders' needs and it also defines the authority of the Project Manager. Having a strong communication channel and conflict management understanding makes project managers more advantageous...

A project isn't a project until the project charter is approved, and the project charter cannot be started until the business case is approved.

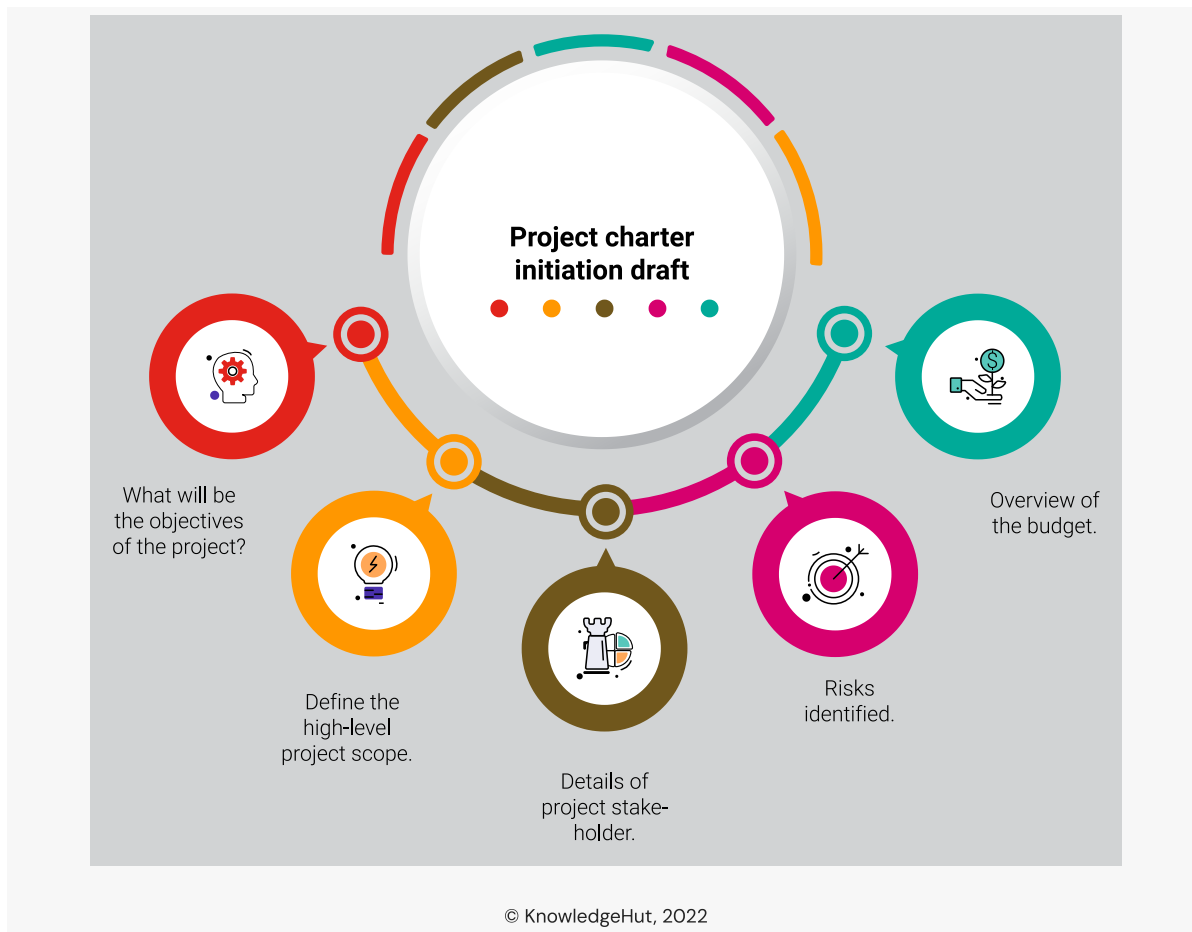
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(Bhagia, 2022)

Figure 2.9 shows the project charter initiation draft defined.

Figure 2.9

The project charter initiation draft



What is included in the project charter?

A project charter document explains the project in concise wording excluding a lot of detailed information and it is created for management needs. Look at Figure 2.10 below for a project charter template with example data.

Figure 2.10

Project charter template with example data

Project charter template with example data

General project information

Project name		Project manager	Project sponsor
Positive charge EMV station installations		Jane Matthews	Jill DeGrassio
Email	Phone	Organisational units(s)	
jane.mathews@positivecharge.com	000-000-0000	Field engineering, operations and project management	
Green belts assigned		Expected start date	Expected completion
Wendy Williams (Project management)		2/19/20XX	11/30/20XX
Black belts assigned		Expected savings	Estimated costs
Rakesh Agarwal (Director of Operations)		\$237,750	\$441,855

Project overview

Problem or issue	Our goal for this project is to install 1,125 EV charging stations at 116 locations across the US, Mexico and Canada to accommodate malls' and service stations' EV-charging needs.
Purpose of project	The implementation of the 1,125 EV charging stations will reduce fossil-fuel emissions, and have a positive impact on the environment. This will help fulfill Positive Charge's mission of being the world's largest EV-charging provider and reduce the environmental impact of fossil-fuel cars through our services.
Business case	As EVs become more prevalent, more EV-charging stations are needed to accommodate EV drivers' charging needs. The implementation of the 1,125 EV charging stations at 116 locations across the US, Mexico and Canada to accommodate malls' and service stations' EV-charging 'traffic' will reduce the lengths to which EV drivers would have to travel for their next charge. The implementation of the EV-charging stations will also result in a 24% profit for Positive Charge.
Goal/ metrics	The project goal is to install 1,125 EV charging stations at 116 locations across the US, Mexico and Canada. The metrics used to measure success will primarily be the following Key performance indicators (KPIs): Revenue Growth, Client Retention Rate, and Customer Satisfaction.
Expected deliverables	Install 1,125 EV charging stations at 116 locations across the US, Mexico and Canada to accommodate malls' and service stations' EV-charging needs.

Project scope

Within scope	Operations engineers, project managers and field implementation engineers will work with third-party client site personnel to install 1,125 EV charging stations at 116 locations across the US, Mexico and Canada.
Outside of scope	Positive charge is not responsible for third-party / clients locations preparatory work (e.g. permits for digging, city region electricity-availability logistics, etc.). However, Positive Charge project managers can provide clients with a checklist to ensure their locations are adequately prepared for the installation of our EV charging stations.

Tentative schedule

Key milestone	Start	Finish
Form project team/preliminary review/scope	12/05/20xx	01/11/20xx
Finalise project plan/charter/kick off	12/06/20xx	02/01/20xx
Define phase	12/07/20xx	02/02/20xx
Measurement phase	12/08/20xx	02/10/20xx
Analysis phase	12/09/20xx	02/26/20xx
Improvement phase	01/10/20xx	03/10/20xx
Control phase	02/08/20xx	03/18/20xx
Project summary report and close out	04/23/20xx	06/23/20xx

Resources

Project team	Janine Remigio – Project Manager David Coen – Chief Engineer Rita Preze – CFO	Lisa Jones – QA Director Donald Smythe – Field Engineer
Support resources	Operations, Sales, Project Management, Engineering	
Special needs	TBD	

Costs

Cost type	Vendor/Labour names	Rate	Qty	Amount
Labour	Electro Charge Logistics, Inc.	\$78.00	200	\$ 15,600.00
Labour	Level 1 EVS	\$46.00	100	\$ 4,600.00
Labour	Level 2 EVS	\$38.00	50	\$ 2,900.00
Labour	EVS Fast Chargers	\$85,000.00	1	\$ 85,000.00
Labour	Battery Vendor	\$79,879.00	3	\$ 239,637.00
Supplies	Power Conversion System Vendor	\$68,686.00	1	\$ 68,686.00
Miscellaneous	Third-Party Software	\$25,432.00	1	\$ 25,432.00
Total costs				\$ 441,855.00

Benefits and customers

Process owner	Jane Matthews – Project Manager
Key stakeholders	Jill DeGrassio
Final customer	116 clients across the US, Mexico and Canada (see attached client list).
Expected Benefits	The implementation of the 1,125 EV charging stations at 116 locations across the US, Mexico and Canada to accommodate malls' and service stations' EV-charging 'traffic' will reduce the lengths to which EV drivers would have to travel for their next charge. The implementation of the EV-charging stations will also result in a 24% profit for Positive Charge.

Type of benefit	Basis of estimate	EST benefit AMT
Specific cost savings	Estimator's projections	\$ 25,000.00
Enhanced revenues	Finance's projections	\$ 92,500.00
Higher productivity (soft)	Project management's estimations	\$ 17,500.00
Improved compliance	Operations' estimations	\$ 12,000.00
Better decision making	Project management's estimations	\$ 18,500.00
Less maintenance	Project management's estimations	\$ 26,000.00
Other costs avoided	Finance's projections	\$ 46,250.00
Total benefit		\$ 237,750.00

Risks, constraints and assumptions

Risks	Though contract is signed, operations still does not have approval for installation from cities of Denver and Yuma. Project management to work with both cities to ensure proper permitting, etc. in time for scheduled installations.
Constraints	We have to backfill some key project management and field engineer positions to ensure we have people 'on the ground' to manage EV stations' implementation.
Assumptions	We assume that all permits for installation of EV-charging stations will be provided by clients by time of implementation.

Prepared by	Title	Date
Jane Matthews	Senior Project Manager	04/22/20XX

(Click to expand the image)

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“

A project charter is important in the Project Management, because:

1. It ensures that the project manager understands the sponsor's needs and requirements.
2. It provides vital information needed to get the projects started.
3. It acts as a reference document to make sure everyone (i.e. Project Manager, Stakeholder, Higher Management etc.) are on the same page.

”

(Bhagia, 2022)

← Strategic planning process

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Project management plan development →

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A project management plan, also known as a work plan, outlines the objectives, goals and tasks the organisation needs to achieve for a specific project. Writing an effective project plan requires information on project scope, timetable and deliverables for all project life cycle processes and being extremely specific, systematic and precise, especially when announcing your ideas and execution tactics.

Let's explore the video below to learn how to write a project plan.

Watch

Watch this video "How to write a project plan [11.10 min]" to learn about the project planning process, how to create a project plan what makes for a top-notch project plan outline.

How to Write a Project Plan [PROJECT PLANNING STEPS THAT WORK]



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Project execution tools and techniques

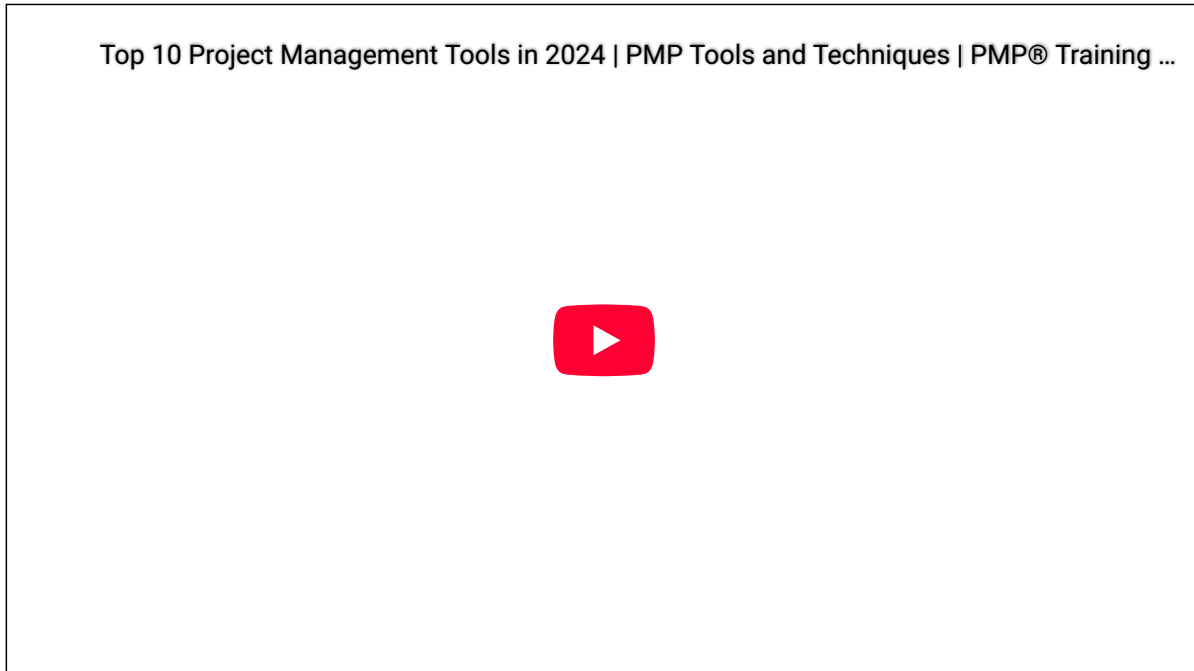
To direct and manage project activities during the execution processes, project managers need three types of specialised tool and techniques, including (PMI, 2017):

- **expert judgement.** Project managers need to apply project knowledge effectively to deliver expected values and outcomes for the stakeholders. A project often spans multiple business domains and requires numerals technical and management skills. Therefore, personal expertise is an essential input for project managers to ensure the successful delivery of a project.
- **meetings.** Meetings are another important communication tool during project execution. Depending on the phase of the project life cycle, meetings should be organised with different stakeholders, with specific purpose and objectives, in various forms and spanning different durations of time. For example, a formal project kick-off meeting should be arranged at the initiation stage of a project involving both stakeholders and the project team; 15-minute daily stand-up meetings are a type of essential event for an Agile project team to keep everyone informed and connected throughout the iterations.
- **project management information systems.** There are numerous project management applications on market today. Large organisations might also have their own enterprise project management systems which track and associate the project management process and the business activities. The data retained in these systems provide valuable information for project

managers, team members and stakeholders to visualise, plan and schedule, communicate and collaborate, monitor and report the performance of the project throughout its life cycle.

Watch

Watch this video "Top 10 project management tools and techniques [12.35 min]" for 10 PMP® tools and techniques mostly preferred by project management professionals.



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Project monitoring and controlling process

PMBOK® describes project monitoring and controlling process group as an umbrella term consisting of '[t]hose processes required to track, review, and regulate the progress and performance of the project; identify any areas in which changes to the plan are required; and initiate the corresponding changes' (PMI, 2017, p. 23).

“

Monitoring is collecting project performance data, producing performance measures, and reporting and disseminating performance information.

Controlling is comparing actual performance with planned performance, analyzing variances, assessing trends to effect process improvements, evaluating possible alternatives, and recommending appropriate corrective action as needed.

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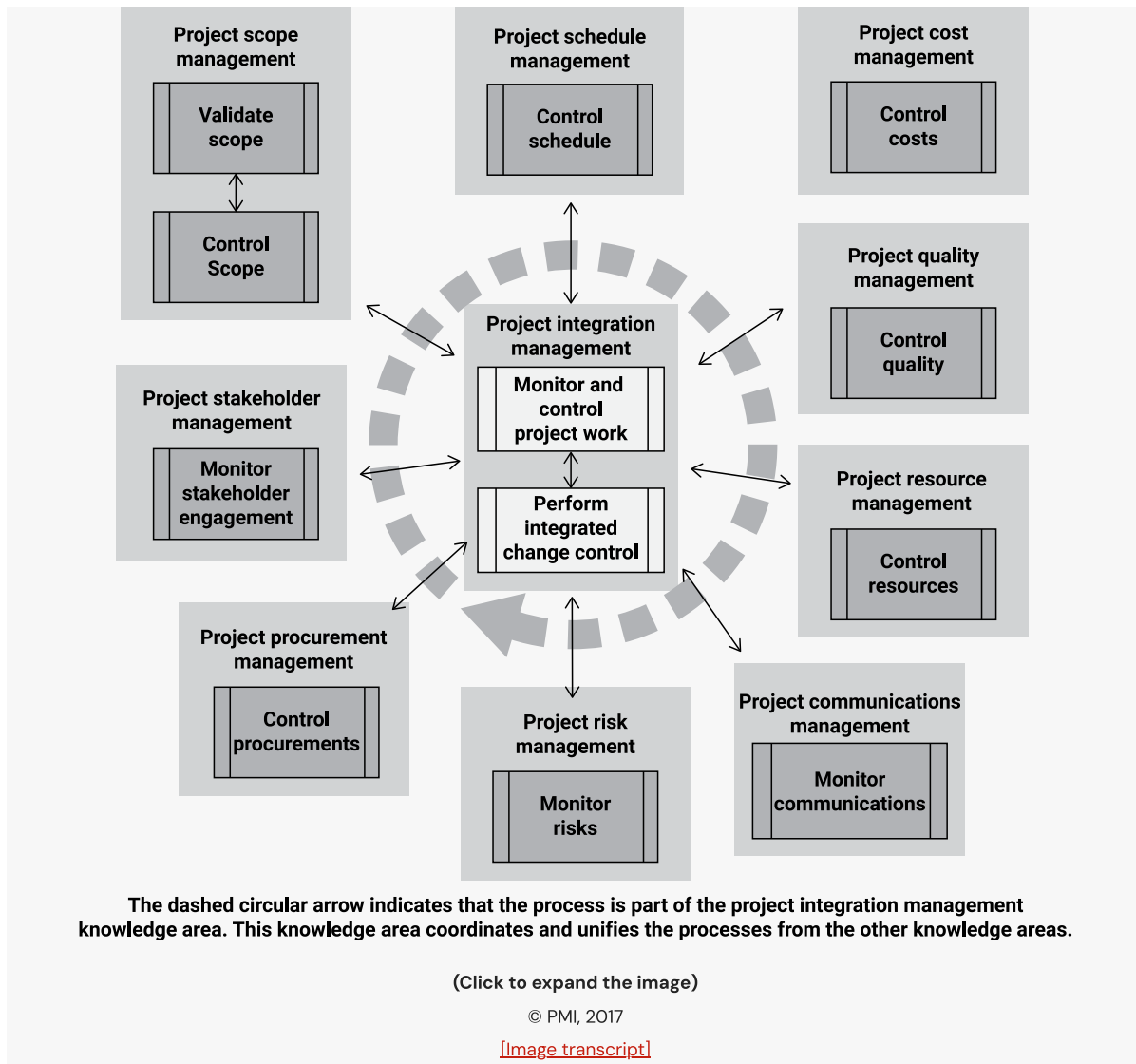
(PMI, 2017, p. 613)

Monitoring and controlling help keep projects on track by measuring and analysing performance metrics at regular intervals and discovering abnormal events at earlier stages.

Figure 2.11 provides an overview of the monitoring and controlling process group.

Figure 2.11

Monitoring and controlling process group



Read

The article [Guide to project monitoring and control phase of project management](#) (Eby, 2022) shares how to create a project and control plan and best practices for monitoring.

← [Project initiation](#)

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[Workshop 4](#) →

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